



🎵 MUSIC ARTIST CAREER COMMAND CENTER

Quick-Start Guide

Your music career backend — built, loaded, and ready to use.

Mirembé Muse — Where Transformation Has a Template

Welcome to Your Command Center

The music industry was not built for independent African artists. It was built to extract talent, dilute culture, and keep creators underpaid and overworked. You already know this. You have probably felt it.

But the landscape is shifting. Distribution is democratised. Audiences are global. A bedroom producer in Johannesburg can reach a listener in Japan at 3am. The tools exist. What most artists are missing is not talent — it is the business infrastructure to match the creative power they already carry.

That is what this command centre is.

Your sound is a business. Your brand is an asset. Your career is a company — and you are the CEO.

This tool is your boardroom.



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💡 What's Inside Your Command Center

This template is different from most Notion systems. Rather than empty databases waiting to be filled, the Music Artist Career Command Center comes **pre-loaded with comprehensive South African music industry data** — ready for you to use immediately.

- 📻 **SA Radio Stations** — 20 stations with contacts, submission formats, genre focus, and pitch timing
- 📰 **Music Press & Blogs** — 20 SA and pan-African music publications with submission guidelines and reach data
- 🎪 **SA Music Festivals** — 18 festivals with booking contacts, artist fee ranges, and application deadlines
- 🏢 **SA Music Industry Contracts** — 20 labels, distributors, publishers, and collecting societies with approach guidance
- 🎧 **Streaming Playlist Targets** — 18 target playlists across Spotify, Apple Music, Boomplay, and Audiomack
- 💰 **Music Grants & Funding** — SA government grants, arts council funding, and private music bursaries
- 📺 **DSP Platform Specs** — Technical requirements, royalty rates, and artist dashboard links for all major platforms
- 🛠️ **Music Technical Specs** — Professional audio standards for masters, files, artwork, and metadata
- 🏟️ **SA Music Venues** — Venue capacity, booker contacts, technical specs, and fee ranges
- 📅 **Music Industry Calendar** — Month-by-month action plan for your music career year



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Before You Begin

You'll need the following to get started:

- A free or paid Notion account (notion.so)
- The template link from your Mirembé Muse purchase confirmation email
- 15–30 minutes to set up and personalise your workspace
- Your artist profile info — genre, stage name, current release plans, social handles

⚡ PRO TIP — THIS TEMPLATE IS ALREADY LOADED Unlike most Notion templates, you do not need to fill these databases from scratch. The industry data is already inside. Your job is to personalise your tracking fields, add your own outreach history, and start working the system.

YOUR NOTION LINK: https://shard-purchase-279.notion.site/Operations-Manual-3181f72e5a6380b39727c4fe246d3082?source=copy_link

Getting Started — Step by Step

- 1. Duplicate the template into your Notion workspace** Click the link in your confirmation email.

https://shard-purchase-279.notion.site/Operations-Manual-3181f72e5a6380b39727c4fe246d3082?source=copy_link

In Notion, click 'Duplicate' in the top right corner. Choose your workspace. All 10 databases — pre-loaded with SA music industry data — will be copied into your account.

- 2. Read the Welcome page first** Open 'Welcome — READ THIS FIRST' inside the template. Read it. It will put you in the right mindset to use this system as a CEO, not just an artist.

3. Start with the Music Industry Calendar Open Music Industry Calendar. Find the current month and read the Action Required column. This is your starting point — it tells you exactly what a professional music artist should be doing right now, regardless of where you are in your career.

4. Identify your radio targets Open SA Radio Stations. Filter by Genre Focus to find the stations most relevant to your sound. For each target station, add your personal tracking fields — whether you have pitched, the response, and your next follow-up date. These fields are yours to customise.

5. Build your press outreach list Open Music Press & Blogs. Review the publications and identify your top 5 targets based on your genre and career stage. Add your outreach status and notes as you pitch each one.

6. Research your festival targets Open SA Music Festivals. Check application deadlines — several festivals open applications months in advance. Identify which festivals fit your genre and career stage. Note the ones with open applications right now.

7. Know your DSP specs before your next release Open DSP Platform Specs. Review the technical requirements and royalty rate information for every platform you distribute to. Cross-reference with Music Technical Specs to ensure your next release meets professional standards.

8. Check your funding options Open Music Grants & Funding. Review which grants you are currently eligible for and when their application windows open. Funding applications take time — identify grants 3–6 months before you need the money.

9. Research venues for your next performance Open SA Music Venues. Filter by Province or City. Note the Booking Lead Time — most venues need 4–12 weeks notice. If you want a show in 2 months, you need to be booking this week.

10. Add personal tracking columns In each database, click the '+' at the end of the column headers to add your own fields: Pitched?, Date Pitched, Response, Follow-Up Date, Status, My Notes. These personalisation columns turn the reference databases into your active outreach tracker.

Your 10 Modules — What Each One Does

SA Radio Stations

20 South African radio stations — contacts, genre focus, submission format, and pitch timing

Key fields: Name, Station Type, Province / Region, Frequency, Genre Focus, Monthly Listeners (Est), Music Director / Contact, Email, Phone, Best Time to Pitch, Submission Format, Submission Notes, SAMRO Tracked?, Target Audience, Social Media

Music Press & Blogs

20 SA and pan-African music publications — submission guidelines, reach, and contact details

Key fields: Name, Type, Country / Region, Focus / Genre, Editor / Contact Name, Email, Website, Social Handle, Reach / Audience, Response Time, Submission Guidelines, Paid Feature?, Notes

SA Music Festivals

18 South African music festivals — booking contacts, fees, deadlines, and genre requirements

Key fields: Name, Province, City / Location, Genre Focus, Typical Month(s), Attendance (Est), Artist Fee Range (ZAR), Application Deadline (Typical), Booker / Programming Contact, Email, Website, Local Artist Slots?, Notes

SA Music Industry Contracts

20 labels, distributors, collecting societies, and publishers — what they do and how to approach them

Key fields: Name, Type, City, Genres / Focus, What They Do for Artists, How to Approach, Key Contact / Department, Email, Phone, Website, Notes

Streaming Playlist Targets

18 target playlists across major platforms — follower counts, submission methods, and genre fit

Key fields: Name, Platform, Playlist Type, Followers (Est), Genre / Mood, Best For (Artist Type), How to Submit, Submission Link / Contact, Ideal Release Window, Notes

Music Grants & Funding

SA and African music funding sources — amounts, eligibility, deadlines, and application guidance

Key fields: Name, Grant / Programme Name, Type, What They Fund, Who Can Apply, Maximum Amount (ZAR), How to Apply, Typical Deadline(s), Turnaround Time, Contact Email, Website, Notes

DSP Platform Specs

Technical specs and royalty data for every major streaming platform

Key fields: Name, Type, Primary Market, Monthly Active Users (Est), Royalty Rate Per Stream (USD), Royalty Rate Per Stream (ZAR Est), Payment Frequency, Payment Threshold, Content Requirements, How to Get on Platform, Playlist Submission, Artist Dashboard, Notes

Music Technical Specs

Professional audio standards — file formats, sample rates, artwork dimensions, and metadata requirements

Key fields: Name, Specification Category, Required Value / Standard, Notes / Why It Matters

SA Music Venues

SA performance venues — capacity, booker contacts, fees, and technical specifications

Key fields: Name, Venue Type, Province, City, Capacity, Typical Artist Fee Range (ZAR), Booking Lead Time, Booker / Events Contact, Email, Phone, Genres That Book, Technical Specs (Summary), Notes

Music Industry Calendar

Month-by-month action plan — what to do, when to do it, and why it matters for your career

Key fields: Name, Week, Type, Event / Deadline, Action Required, Relevance to Artist, Notes

Adding Your Personal Tracking Columns

Because most databases come pre-loaded with industry data, your primary customisation is adding tracking columns that record your own outreach and activity. Add these to any database relevant to your current focus:

For **Radio Stations, Press Blogs, Festivals, and Venues:**

- Pitched? (Checkbox)
- Date Pitched (Date)
- Response Received (Select: No Response / Positive / Declined / Feature Confirmed)
- Follow-Up Date (Date)
- My Notes (Text)

For **Streaming Playlist Targets:**

- Submitted? (Checkbox)
- Date Submitted (Date)
- Track Submitted (Text)
- Result (Select: Pending / Added / Declined)

For **Grants & Funding:**

- Applied? (Checkbox)
- Application Date (Date)
- Amount Applied For (Number)
- Result (Select: Pending / Awarded / Declined)
- Next Application Window (Date)

Your Weekly Career Workflow

When	Action
Monday	Open Music Industry Calendar. Check what this week's action requires. Prioritise accordingly.
Before a release	Open DSP Platform Specs and Music Technical Specs. Confirm your master file, artwork, and metadata meet every platform's requirements before sending to your distributor.
7–28 days before release	Open Streaming Playlist Targets. Submit your track to editorial playlists on Spotify for Artists. Submit to curated playlists via SubmitHub or Groover.
Ongoing – pitching radio	Open SA Radio Stations. Filter by your genre. Check Best Time to Pitch. Send your EPK on the right day, to the right contact, in the right format. Log your outreach in your personal tracking columns.
Ongoing – press pitching	Open Music Press & Blogs. Work through your top 5 targets. Follow submission guidelines exactly. Log responses.
Monthly	Open Music Industry Calendar for the coming month. Note any festival application deadlines, grant deadlines, or industry events. Set reminders 2 weeks in advance.
Quarterly	Review your outreach tracking columns across all databases. What have you pitched? What is your response rate? What needs follow-up?





Tips for Getting the Most Out of Your Command Center

- The Music Industry Calendar is your most underused database. Read it monthly, not just once at setup. It tells you what professional artists are doing right now — and most independent artists are 2–3 months behind on every action it recommends.
- The Best Time to Pitch column in SA Radio Stations is not decoration. Radio music directors receive the most pitches on Mondays. Pitching Tuesday–Thursday in the morning is how you get heard instead of buried.
- Filter SA Music Festivals by Application Deadline immediately after setup. Several festivals close applications 6 months before the event. If you are reading this in August and a festival is in October, you may have already missed the window — but you will know for next year.
- The Royalty Rate Per Stream (ZAR Est) field in DSP Platform Specs tells you the real value of your streams. Use this to set realistic streaming income targets and to decide where to focus your promotion energy.
- SA Music Industry Contracts includes collecting societies (SAMRO, CAPASSO, DALRO) alongside labels and distributors. If you are not yet registered with SAMRO, this is the first action to take — you are leaving royalty money uncollected on every song that plays on SA radio right now.
- Use the Technical Specs database before every single release. One wrong file format or missing metadata field can delay your release by weeks or disqualify you from playlist consideration.



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A Note from Nanda

"The music industry was not built for independent African artists. But independent African artists are rebuilding it.

The contact is in here. The deadline is in here. The grant is in here. The playlist curator is in here. The festival booker is in here.

What happens next depends on whether you open the system and use it or leave it sitting in your Notion sidebar while another artist gets the placement you were qualified for.

Your sound is a business. This is your boardroom.

Go run it."

— **Nandawula Regine Kabali-Kagwa, Founder, Mireembe Muse**

Creative Technologist of Africa

Support & Community

 **Technical Support** Email us with a screenshot and description of any issue. We won't rest until it's working perfectly for you.

 **Muse Collective Community** Join the community of African artists, creators, and builders using Mireembe Muse systems to build extraordinary things.

 **Mireembe Muse — Where Transformation Has a Template**
Release with intention. Pitch with strategy. Build your legacy.



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